

Soil Integrity™

Minimal Self- Declaration Framework

This framework provides a simple method for implementing the Soil Integrity™ Standard through transparent disclosure of soil-based production conditions.

The framework is designed to be easy to apply by both small producers and larger production systems.

No certification body is required.

No external audit is required under the minimal level.

The objective is **structural transparency and declared responsibility**.

Implementation Steps

Step 1 — Declare Soil Environment

The producer identifies the soil environment used in production. Examples:

- Natural soil
- Mixed soil
- Artificial substrate
- Controlled environment soil system

If multiple soil environments are used, each should be declared.

Step 2 — Declare Fertilization Inputs

The producer declares whether fertilization inputs are used.

Declaration includes:

- Fertilization used: Yes / No

If fertilization is used, the category should be declared.

Examples:

- Animal manure
- Plant compost
- Mineral fertilizer
- Synthetic fertilizer
- Sewage-derived fertilizer

No prohibition is imposed.

Transparency is required.

Step 3 — Declare Plant Protection Practices

The producer declares whether plant protection substances are used.

Declaration includes:

- Plant protection used: Yes / No

The declared use should reflect the actual role of water in production.

Examples: Frequency categories:

- Occasional
 - Seasonal
 - Regular
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Step 4 — Responsibility Declaration

The producer publishes a short declaration confirming transparency of soil inputs.

Example declaration: “This production is declared under the Soil Integrity™ Standard. Soil environment, fertilization inputs, and plant protection practices are transparently disclosed under producer responsibility.”

The declaration may be published

- on a website
 - on a product sheet
 - on supplier documentation
 - via QR code reference
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Documentation Requirements

Implementation requires only:

- one soil disclosure sheet
- one input declaration
- one public responsibility statement

No certification required.

No external audit required under the minimal implementation level.

Structural Value

Soil Integrity™ transforms:

hidden soil inputs
into
declared production transparency.

This strengthens:

- buyer confidence
 - supply chain clarity
 - environmental accountability
 - long-term production credibility
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Closing Principle

Transparent soil inputs create credible soil-based production systems.

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